

MacroLens Daily Brief — August 25, 2026

Automated macro briefing generated by MacroLens AI

Top Headlines

1. Six months into Iran war, almost half of global oil flows from war zones - Reuters

Reuters — 2026-08-25 20:27

Six months into the Iran war, nearly half of global oil flows now originate from war zones, heightening supply disruption risks and supporting elevated crude prices.

2. Trump says Strait of Hormuz has been demined, warns Iran not to plant more - Reuters

Reuters — 2026-08-25 15:05

President Trump announced the Strait of Hormuz has been demined and warned Iran against re-mining, reducing immediate threats to oil transit through the key chokepoint.

3. European shares climb on softer-than-feared Iran sanctions, defence gains - Reuters

Reuters — 2026-08-25 09:24

European shares rose as US sanctions on Iran proved softer than feared, with defense stocks leading gains on increased geopolitical tensions.

4. Oil settles down more than 3%; investors shrug off US sanctions on Iran - Reuters

Reuters — 2026-08-25 01:16

Oil settled down over 3% as investors dismissed US sanctions on Iran as insufficient to disrupt supply, easing earlier war premium in crude prices.

5. Gold steadies after hitting over 3-month peak ahead of US inflation data - Reuters

Reuters — 2026-08-25 02:10

Gold steadied after hitting a three-month peak, with traders positioning ahead of US inflation data that could influence Federal Reserve policy.

6. Dollar fragile as investors weigh Iran sanctions, Treasury buybacks - Reuters

Reuters — 2026-08-25 01:31

The dollar remained fragile as markets weighed the impact of Iran sanctions and potential Treasury buybacks, adding uncertainty to currency valuations.

7. Equities rise with tech boost and yields fall with oil prices - Reuters

Reuters — 2026-08-25 01:26

Equities gained on tech sector strength while Treasury yields fell alongside declining oil prices, reflecting easing inflation concerns.

8. **S&P 500, Nasdaq end down on tech stocks, investors weigh Iran moves - Reuters**

Reuters — 2026-08-24 22:26

The S&P 500 and Nasdaq closed lower as tech stocks sold off, with investors assessing the market implications of US actions toward Iran.

9. **Treasury yields steady as traders await more economic data**

CNBC — 2026-08-25 07:48

Treasury yields fell sharply as oil slid over 3% on sanctions-based Iran strategy, with 10-year at 4.629%; consumer confidence dropped to 89.4, and markets await PCE data and Jackson Hole speech.

10. **Bond rout ending? Massive bets on bond rally dominate options market**

CNBC — 2026-08-25 19:42

Options traders heavily bought bullish calls on long-duration Treasury ETF TLT, betting on a bond rally; TLT rose 0.9% to \$83.30, with PCE data, Nvidia earnings, and Jackson Hole ahead.

Market Snapshot

Ticker	Name	Price	1D Return	Signal
US Equities				
SPY	S&P 500 ETF	763.47	-0.29%	neutral
QQQ	Nasdaq 100 ETF	706.32	-1.00%	bearish
DIA	Dow Jones ETF	533.65	+0.27%	neutral
IWM	Russell 2000 ETF	297.97	-0.66%	bearish
XLK	Technology ETF	180.05	-1.78%	bearish
XLF	Financials ETF	58.22	+1.29%	bullish
US Treasuries				
SHY	2Y Treasury ETF	82.00	+0.00%	neutral
IEF	10Y Treasury ETF	93.01	+0.20%	neutral
TLT	20Y+ Treasury ETF	82.56	+0.62%	bullish
Credit				
LQD	Investment Grade Bond ETF	106.18	+0.25%	neutral
HYG	High Yield Bond ETF	79.70	+0.11%	neutral

Ticker	Name	Price	1D Return	Signal
Commodities				
GLD	Gold ETF	426.69	+0.79%	bullish
SLV	Silver ETF	62.20	-0.83%	bearish
USO	Oil ETF	132.21	-1.80%	bearish
UNG	Natural Gas ETF	10.15	+1.60%	bullish
FX				
UUP	US Dollar Index ETF	27.96	+0.22%	neutral
FXE	Euro ETF	107.65	-0.14%	neutral
FXJ	Japanese Yen ETF	57.64	-0.10%	neutral
Crypto				
BTC-USD	Bitcoin	78964.48	+1.56%	bullish
ETH-USD	Ethereum	2481.83	+0.73%	bullish

Key Macro Indicators

Indicator	Value	As Of
Fed Funds Rate Target	3.5% – 3.75%	2026-08-25
10Y Breakeven Inflation (%)	2.32	2026-08-25
10Y-2Y Yield Spread (bp)	0.47	2026-08-25
VIX	15.85	2026-08-24
USD Index (Broad)	118.0628	2026-08-21

No Major Anomalies

No assets moved more than ±2% today.

Macro Data Releases — Today

[Calendar error: 403 Client Error: Forbidden for url: https://finnhub.io/api/v1/calendar/economic?from=2026-08-25&to=2026-09-02&token=d88f5hpr01qq4342ton0d88f5hpr01qq4342tong]

Economic Calendar — Next 7 Days

No upcoming macro events in the next 7 days.

Sector Heat Map

Sector Performance Heatmap			
	1D	5D	1M
Consumer Discretionary	+0.2%	+1.3%	+8.1%
Healthcare	+0.1%	+4.6%	+7.5%
Energy	-0.8%	+0.8%	+5.8%
Communication Services	+0.8%	+1.4%	+5.7%
Materials	+0.1%	+2.6%	+4.5%
Consumer Staples	+1.7%	+3.3%	+4.0%
Financials	+1.3%	+1.1%	+3.4%
Technology	-1.8%	-5.4%	+2.4%
Real Estate	+0.6%	+1.1%	-1.4%
Industrials	-0.7%	-3.9%	-2.0%
Utilities	+1.1%	-2.2%	-6.6%

Hot Now

- **XLV** — Strong 1-month gains and positive short-term momentum
- **XLV** — Robust 5-day and 1-month performance, indicating sustained strength
- **XLC** — Positive across all timeframes, with solid 1-month gain

Cold but Worth Watching

- **XLU** — Significant 1-month decline, but recent 1-day bounce suggests potential reversal
- **XLI** — Negative 5-day and 1-month, but 1-day dip may offer value
- **XLK** — Sharp 5-day drop, but 1-month still positive, possible oversold bounce

Defensive and consumer sectors are leading, while technology and industrials face short-term weakness, presenting potential mean-reversion opportunities.

Daily Conclusion

Despite the absence of market anomalies or macro surprises, the dominant theme is a risk-on rotation into consumer discretionary, healthcare, and communication services, as investors look past the severe geopolitical supply shock from the prolonged Iran war.

Generated: 2026-08-25 21:29 UTC | MacroLens v1.0